



TLD GROUP IT Policy

Purpose

The purpose of this document is to define common IT rules and procedures that must be followed by all within the whole TLD GROUP in order to insure:

- reliable connectivity and data exchange between all users
- optimal data security and confidentiality

There may be some special cases where Group Connectivity and Security rules conflict with Local Connectivity and Security rules. In these situations, compromises may be taken but the final decision is to be taken by the TLD Steering committee.

The TLD Steering committee has given the TLD GROUP IT Coordinator the effective responsibility for proposing, auditing and controlling all subjects in the IT field. All IT local managers shall communicate transparently and diligently with the TLD GROUP IT Coordinator for all IT related subjects. Any network modification should always be submitted for approval to the TLD GROUP IT Coordinator before implementation.

It is the responsibility of the local management to insure that these rules are followed and respected in each of their locations. It is also their responsibility to insure that the relevant local IT procedures meeting the local laws and the IT Group policy are written.

1. Network:

The Group network is divided into three major WANs (Wide Area Network): TLD Europe, TLD Asia and TLD USA. Each WAN is comprised of LANs (Local Area Networks) in all major facility locations. All three WANs are linked together using VPN connections to form the TLD GROUP WAN. TLD WAN coordination and connectivity is insured by the TLD GROUP IT Coordinator.

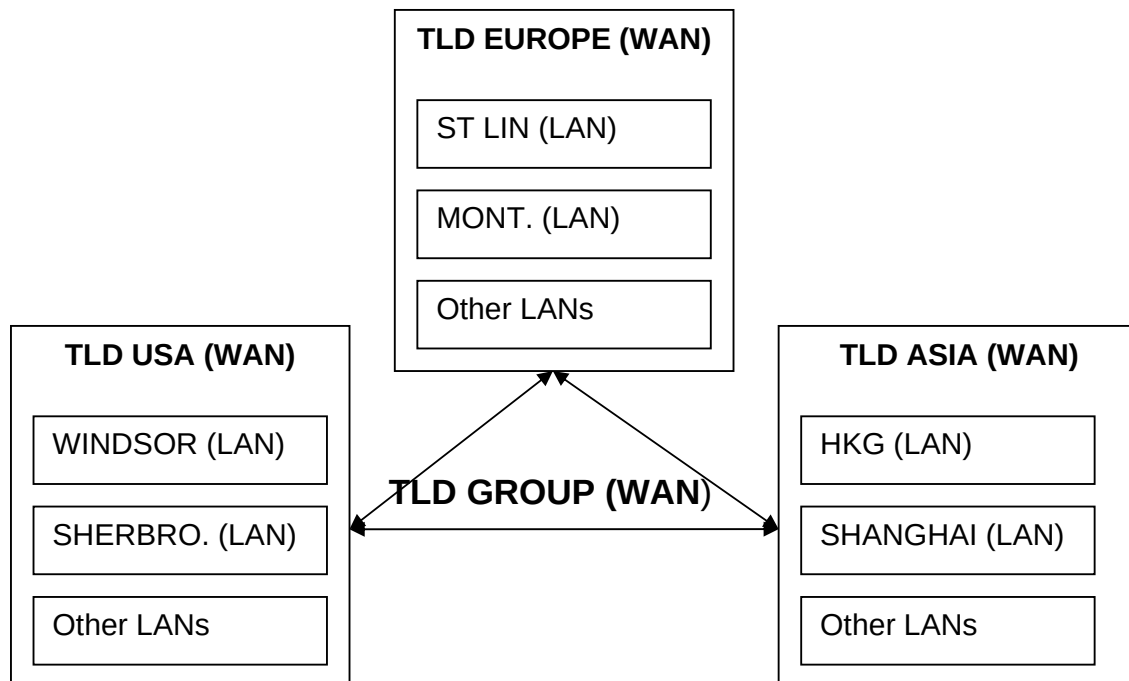


Figure 1, TLD Group WAN Schematic

Each local network is to be protected by firewalls whose settings must be consistent with [Group Firewall Policies](#).

The use of wired networking equipment takes priority over Wireless Networking (WiFi). WiFi may be used only when necessary and only when TLD offices are not located in a building common with other non-TLD offices. WIFI communications encryption is mandatory for data protection. The TLD GROUP IT Coordinator will provide a key to be used by all WiFi equipment within the TLD WAN. A 'key' may be looked at as being similar to a password. This key will be changed every 60 days and communicated to all IT Managers in order to update equipment configurations.

In order to provide easy access and navigation of data all files should be stored in accordance with the [TLD Network Data Security Policy](#)

2. Hardware:

The standard Group hardware platform is the IBM Compatible PC. Other platforms, such as Apple Macintosh, may not be used unless authorized by an IT Manager.

There are three main TLD user categories roughly defined by Hardware and software requirements:

- Frequent travellers, remotely located personnel and Managers: These are typically equipped with laptop computers and MS OFFICE software.
- Engineering personnel: Equipped with powerful workstations and relevant software.
- Sedentary personnel: Equipped with low end PC's or thin clients and connected to Terminal Services.

Users' accounts should never be administrators of their own machine, only IT people are administrators of the PC's. Only, some selected Frequent travellers users have access to the administrator level of their PC with a different account than the one they use daily.

3. Software:

Software used within the TLD GROUP must have the correct license. The usage of pirated software is absolutely forbidden.

It is the responsibility of the local IT Manager to administer software licences and to insure that no illegal or pirated software is installed on any company's computer

Utilizing, downloading or installing non approved software from the internet is forbidden. Each user is liable for the non approved or pirated software he would have himself installed on his computer.

The usage of peer to peer software is totally forbidden.

Any software that is a burden on network connectivity requires approval by an IT manager e.g. streaming video, streaming radio. If in doubt, the IT Manager must be contacted for approval.

Except other wise expressed, the following [TLD list of software](#) represents the list of approved and maintained software within the Group.

4. Emails:

TLD uses its own email servers, one per major geographical area (TLD Asia, TLD Europe and TLD America).

For confidentiality purposes, only one IT manager is allowed to have access to the email software. The three IT managers share their access so the other one can intervene on the other server whenever the other one is not available. Each email account is protected by a password

All professional Emails and business related messages remain TLD property and need to be filed properly in order that others in the Group may easily retrieve

information in the necessary cases. This is the sole responsibility of each user and his management.

Applicable laws and regulation concerning access to employees' messages shall be applied by Management.

5. Security:

IT security is a very important concern for TLD. All viable means to protect our systems must be put in place as long as it does not affect seriously our ability to communicate and exchange information. Final decision regarding potential compromises between security and connectivity is at the sole discretion of the TLD Steering Committee.

Each PC in TLD shall be protected from Viruses by an up-to-dated version of an approved anti virus software. Emails receiving and forwarding shall be under the protection of this anti virus software. Live Update of viruses and full scan shall be processed automatically at least once a week.

For all computers of TLD, computer and network access must be controlled by password. Email access is also protected by passwords.

Passwords must be at least 6 characters long, must be changed at least every 2 months and cannot be one of the six previous passwords.

Passwords and access rights are provided to the users by the IT managers at the request of the Human Resource Department. These passwords are individual, totally confidential and not shared with Human Resources. No generic passwords (like "Engineering", "Purchasing", "Trainee"...for example) are allowed within TLD. When people are leaving the company, it is the responsibility of the Human Resource Department to inform, in a very timely manner, the IT managers to cancel the relevant networks access and passwords.

Whenever a new TLD employee is hired (temporary employees also) and is given network access and passwords, this person should be informed by the HR department about confidentiality and security and should sign the relevant local policy.

HR managers should always provide written notices to IT managers on these very important subjects. IT Managers shall always confirm by written notice that they acknowledge and have done what was requested by the HR managers.

All Internet facing servers must be regularly monitored and updated at least once a week. All internal servers must be updated at least once per month.

All IT personnel should subscribe to mailing lists or frequently visit websites, for system bug alerts pertaining to their server operating systems e.g. windows and redhat linux.

6. Data Backup:

Data backup is a critical task that must be taken extremely seriously.

Local computers:

Each computer user who stores data on his local hard drive e.g. laptops and workstations, is responsible for the periodic backup of all data to a designated TLD Server. This backup must be done periodically at least once a week.

Remotely located employees who do not have easy access to TLD servers must be taken care especially by the IT people who have to decide together the best way and tools to insure good data backups. In all cases, at least once a month, the IT managers should insure that they can have easy access to a data media with complete backup.

IT managers are responsible for providing each user the right network access, tools and training to backup their data and randomly monitor that backups are being done by each user in accordance with the above policy.

If either party does not perform its duty then it must be relayed immediately to upper management. Failure to do so is a fault but does not relinquish either party from being held accountable.

Servers:

- Server backups are to be done on a daily basis according to local written procedures.
- Backup media must never be located in the same building as the server itself.
- Server backups are under the responsibility of Local IT Managers although in case of remote location, the process itself may be sometimes delegated to well identified and trained other people.

More detailed and technical backup procedures are developed in the here-attached document [TLD backup guidelines](#).